

Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit Template

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Project Name	An employee or students submits an innovation idea through the Innovation Hub, where it is reviewed by a reviewer and approved or rejected by a manager.
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

Establishing a Problem–Solution Fit for InnovateHub: Innovation Idea Portal ensures that the application addresses the real challenges faced by employees during idea submission, review, and approval. The system replaces manual processes such as emails and spreadsheets with a centralized ServiceNow platform that automates the complete innovation lifecycle. By understanding user needs and organizational workflows, the application provides secure role-based access, transparent status tracking, and efficient collaboration between employees, reviewers, and managers.

Purpose:

The purpose of the Problem–Solution Fit is to verify that the proposed solution effectively solves the identified business problems. It ensures that InnovateHub improves idea management, reduces manual effort, increases transparency, accelerates approvals, and encourages employee participation in organizational innovation.

Template:

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) CS Who is your customer? Employees (idea submitters), Reviewers (department experts), and Managers (approvers) across the organization who participate in the innovation process.	6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS CC What constraints prevent your customers from using solutions or limit their choices? Lack of a centralized platform, time constraints, unclear review process, limited visibility into idea status, manual communication, and restricted access to idea information.	5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS AS Which solutions are available to the customer and prevent you from being chosen? What other ways might your customers be achieving the goal? Emails, spreadsheets, paper forms, shared drives, and informal discussions for idea submission and tracking.
2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS J&P What is your customer (or segment) trying to get done? What problems do they face? Submit innovative ideas easily, track idea status, get timely feedback, ensure ideas are reviewed and approved fairly, and contribute to organizational innovation.	9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE RC Why do these problems exist today? What in the backstory behind the need to do this job? No centralized system, manual handoffs, lack of role-based visibility, no automated workflow, and absence of real-time notifications and tracking.	7. BEHAVIOUR BE What does your customer do to address the problem and get the job done? What are their habits? Employees share ideas via email or meetings, follow up manually, reviewers check shared documents, and managers approve through offline communication.
3. TRIGGERS TR What event or situation triggers the customer to act? New idea or improvement thought, innovation challenges, organizational needs, process gaps, or customer feedback.	10. YOUR SOLUTION SL What is your solution to your customer's problem? InnovateHub: Innovation Idea Portal on ServiceNow – a centralized platform to submit ideas, automate review and approval workflows, track status in real-time, send notifications, and generate reports and dashboards.	8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR CH How do customers access solutions to get the job done? 8.1 ONLINE InnovateHub portal, ServiceNow Workspace, email notifications, mobile access. 8.2 OFFLINE Team meetings, offline discussions, printed documents (current manual method).
4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER EM How does your customer feel before getting the job done? How do they feel after? BEFORE - Uncertain about idea acceptance - Frustrated due to lack of visibility - Delays in feedback and approvals - Unsure about whom to follow up	AFTER - Confident after easy submission - Happy with real-time tracking - Satisfied with timely feedback - Motivated to contribute more ideas	8. BENEFITS & VALUE BV What is the measurable value your customer gains from your solution? - Centralized idea management - Transparency and real-time visibility - Faster reviews and approvals - Increased employee engagement - Better innovation outcomes

Reference:

1. <https://www.lucidchart.com/pages/what-is-a-workflow?>
2. <https://www.atlassian.com/agile?>
3. <https://www.visual-paradigm.com/guide/uml-unified-modeling-language/what-is-use-case-diagram/?>